

Graphics - Apple provides the designer's Garden of Eden

As far as graphics cards go, the Mac range uses a variety of chips, all robust and high-powered, some more than others. The iMac is available with the nifty Radeon Pro series with 4 to 8 GB of video RAM. As usual, the mini underdelivers, without the benefit of Apple's high-def screens, not really requiring powerful GPUs - it is bundled with the Intel Iris series. The Mac Pro, the beast that it is, has Dual AMD FirePro graphics processors, with a performance of upto 3.5 teraflops. Like the Mac Pro, the iMac Pro comes fully equipped for heavy-duty design, processing and video editing usage. It will have the Radeon Pro Vega 56, with 8 gigs of video memory.

Retina Display - beauty in the eye of the Mac beholder

Retina Display, first introduced by Apple for the 2010 iPhone 4, is a brand name used by the company for their high-resolution displays. On average, it implies a detail of at least 300 pixels per inch, such that individual pixels remain impossible to discern for a viewer at the typical computer to eye distance. The versions of the Mac that include Apple's display monitor - the iMac and the iMac Pro - have Retina 4K (4096 x 2304 with one billion colours) and Retina 5K (5120 x 2880 also with one billion colours) displays, respectively. Chucking the numbers, here's what you need to know - in theory with a Retina Display monitor, it's impossible to discern individual pixels without either taking a high-def photograph of the screen and zooming in, or using a magnifying glass. Or maybe holding your face up close to the screen.

Storage - how much to hold?

A standard tradeoff on Apple machines is low hard disk space to accommodate the slender frames. With the push towards cloud-based storage, Apple has disappointed several loyal customers in the recent past with ridiculously low hard disk space. The Mac series, however, is usually more functional when it comes to this. Built to be larger, sturdier, and less portable/more practical, all models but the Mac Pro (built more for processing that large amounts of storage) offer at least 500 gigs of storage.

Some versions of the Mac also offer the option of a Fusion Drive, the Apple implementation of a hybrid drive. This tech combines a standard hard disk drive with a decent-sized solid state drive (SSD) and presents it to the Operating System as a combined logical volume.

The iMac and Mac mini offer upto 1 TB of Fusion Drive space, though lower-budget models with simple hard disks are also available. The Mac